General rule – damage, Resistance and Vulnerability · "Playing the Game" chapter of SRD 5.2.1

Every attack, spell or trap deals damage of **a given type**. **Resistance** halves it, **Vulnerability** doubles it, and **Immunity** negates it. A critical hit **doubles the damage dice**.

Temporary Hit Points absorb damage first. They don't stack: keep the higher. They don't heal and don't count as healing.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. Compute damage, add bonuses and penalties.
2. Apply **Resistance** (÷ 2, round down).
3. Then **Vulnerability** (× 2).
4. Immunity: no damage of that type.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 fixes the order: modifiers first, then Resistance, then Vulnerability; several sources of Resistance (or Vulnerability) to the same type count as one.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The text doesn't say how to round when Resistance and Vulnerability both apply. Fix: follow the order (Resistance, then Vulnerability).

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe the damage type's effect (fire blackens, cold frosts) to make Resistance vivid.

Step 1 – Identify the type:

Bludgeoning, Piercing, Slashing, or Fire, Cold, Acid, etc. The weapon or spell tells you.

Step 2 – Roll the damage:

Add modifiers. On a critical hit, double the **dice** (not the modifiers).

Step 3 – Resistance:

Halve it, round down.

Step 4 – Vulnerability:

Double it. Only one Resistance and one Vulnerability per type.

Step 5 – Subtract:

Remove Temporary Hit Points first, then Hit Points.

Example: a longsword deals 7 (slashing). Against a creature Resistant to slashing: 3 (7 ÷ 2, rounded down); against one Vulnerable to slashing: 14.

Type	Examples
Bludgeoning	Club, hammer, fall
Piercing	Dagger, arrow, bite
Slashing	Sword, axe, claws
Fire	Fireball, dragon breath
Cold	Ray of Frost, Ice Storm
Lightning	Lightning Bolt, Call Lightning
Thunder	Thunderwave, sonic blast
Acid	Acid Arrow, ooze
Poison	Venom, Stinking Cloud
Necrotic	Vampiric Touch, Blight
Radiant	Sacred Flame, Flame Strike
Force	Magic Missile
Psychic	Mind spikes, mental scream

⚠ Common questions:

Resistance and odd damage?

Halve it and round down.

Do critical hit dice double?

Yes: all damage dice, not the modifiers.

Several Resistances to one type?

They don't stack: only one counts.

Do Temporary Hit Points stack?

No: keep the higher.

Vulnerability and Resistance?

Apply Resistance, then Vulnerability.

Damage reduced to zero?

No damage, no effect.

What is massive damage?

If the leftover damage after dropping to 0 HP equals your Hit Point maximum, you die.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Multiple damage types

A spell deals two types: each is evaluated separately. **Option**: keep it.

Partial Resistance

Resistance to nonmagical weapons only. **Option**: follow the description.

Rounding

Always round down. **Option**: keep it.

Bonus damage

Extra damage of the same type: evaluated together. **Option**: keep it.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Critical hit

A critical doubles damage dice; flat bonuses are not doubled.

Temp HP

They absorb damage before normal HP and vanish after a Long Rest.

Massive damage

Remaining at 0 HP with leftover damage ≥ HP maximum = instant death.

Multiple types

For a multi-type spell, Resistance applies to each type separately.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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